

9.

The reactionary policies of Lord Lytton and the liberal policies of his successor Lord Rippon acted as catalyst in the formation of the Indian National Congress. Discuss. (Answer in 150 words)

लॉर्ड लिटन की प्रतिक्रियावादी नीतियों और उनके उत्तराधिकारी लॉर्ड रिपन की उदार नीतियों ने भारतीय राष्ट्रीय कांग्रेस के गठन में उत्प्रेरक का कार्य किया। चर्चा कीजिए।

Among the many facets accounting for the "Rise of Nationalism", the ~~radi~~ racial discrimination through policies of Lord Lytton and Rippon played a vital role in the intellectual awakening of India, paving the way for the formation of Indian National Congress.

Discriminatory policies of Lord Lytton

- 1) Reducing the maximum age of Indians in Indian Civil Services  $\Rightarrow$  Moral impoverishment of Indians.
- 2) Lavish Durbar of 1877 - was organized despite Indians facing disastrous Famine.
- 3) Vernacular Press Act, 1878 - imposed restrictions on the freedom of Press, making Indians more aware about the "intent" of British Authority.
- 4) Arms act, 1878 - Indians need a license for acquiring firearms.
- 5) Funding the II<sup>nd</sup> Anglo Afghan war (1878-80) by heavily taxing Indians. This fueled a wave

of Nationalism among Indians that they are being taxed so that the so called "whites" can live prosperously.

### Liberal policy of Lord Rippon

① Ilbert Bill Controversy (1883) - The Ilbert Bill, though introduced in Britain's parliament to end judicial disqualification based on racial distinction, faced "extreme opposition" in Parliament ⇒ Even a ~~son~~ "white convict" stands on a higher footing than a so called "Black Indian Judge".

Thus, the formation of Indian National Congress (INC) transformed scattered resistance into organized political consciousness. What British saw as a "safety valve", became a "lightning conductor" that soon ignited the National Consciousness by uniting diverse sections of Indian society and creating an ideological foundation for India's struggle for SWARAJ.